

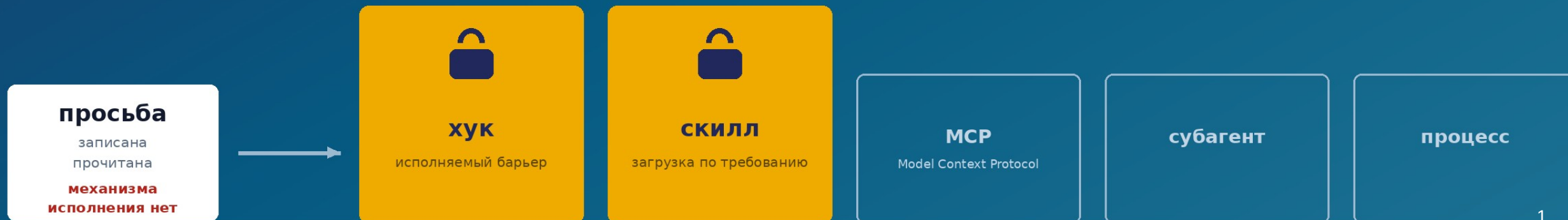
When a request is not enough: a barrier and on-demand loading

"The agent in this project is configured by twenty-four lines of text. It reads them. There is no mechanism in the project that would carry them out."

"An instruction file is a request. What do you put next to it so that a rule gets enforced without depending on the agent's decision?"

сегодня — две из пяти

следующее занятие — три



Where we left off

signup-landing — a static landing page with a submission form for a trial lesson. Readiness is defined like this: the build finishes with code 0, the test suite passes in full, the form has been submitted by hand — both filled in and empty.

```
README.md      spec.md      DECISIONS.md    ← what we build and why
CLAUDE.md      AGENTS.md (symlink to CLAUDE.md) ← 24 lines, 19 non-empty, 4 sections
doc/adr/       template + 3 ADRs + README.md    ← how decisions were made
.tasks/        README.md · active/ · done/README.md ← task memory
index.html     package.json      package-lock.json
vite.config.js playwright.config.ts
src/main.js    src/style.css      src/validate.js  ← the product
tests/form.spec.ts tests/delivery.spec.ts
tests/page-objects/form.page.ts
.gitignore

.clause/ — not there at all: no hook, no skill, no subagent, no configured server
```

Repository: github.com/tellina-study/signup-landing-demo, branch main.

"Everything listed is text. The agent may take it into account, and may not."

Five reinforcements that get placed next to an instruction file



Five mechanisms get placed next to an instruction file. One line each — what it is, what sets it going, and whether it transfers to another tool.

REINFORCEMENT	WHAT IT IS	DOES IT TRANSFER
Hook	A command that the environment runs on its own at a set moment in the agent's work.	The practice — everyone has it. The way it is written down — everyone's is their own; some agents have no mechanism at all.
Skill	A procedure in a separate file ; the agent opens it itself.	An open format — dozens of agents read the same file.
MCP	Model Context Protocol — a connection to an external system; through it the agent reaches data the repository does not hold.	An open protocol — it has a neutral owner and a shared specification.
Subagent	A separate role with reduced permissions ; you start it on one task and get back only the result.	The practice — everyone has it. The declaration format — everyone's is their own.
Process	The way the work is ordered, written down as files : a plan, a record kept as you go, a check before handing over.	Transfers in full — these are ordinary files, no mechanism required.

What would you set up first in this repository

Twenty-four lines of instructions, four sections — and not one mechanism that would carry them out.

In this repository — with its submission form, its tests and its twenty-four lines of instructions — which of the five would you set up first? Keep your answer to yourself: this question will be asked a second time today.

hook

skill

MCP

subagent

process

Two stages, six decision points

хук	Агент не исполняет процедуру работы с репозиторием решаем чем заставить агента её исполнять	Проверка работала и молча перестала решаем чем её починить	Агент стал работать медленнее из-за хуков решаем что делать с ценой проверок
скилл	Одно правило объявлено в файле дважды, копии разошлись решаем что делать с файлом инструкций	Агент не открывает нужный скилл и открывает ненужный решаем по чему он решает открыть файл	Задача стоит сегодня, а своё решение — это недели решаем брать готовое или писать своё

следующее занятие: MCP · субагент · процесс

By the end of the session the repository tree will differ from the one shown on the second slide by exactly two lines.

Two rows of the axis are closed

The second row is filled in. The same five reinforcements as at the start of the session — two of them now have a measurement.

STAGE	PREVENTING / SOLVING	WHAT THE MECHANISM PROMISES	WHAT THE CHECK SHOWED
Hook	Solving — the rule has already been broken	"We installed a hook, so commits to main are closed"	Of six forms of one command it rejects one and stays silent on five; a person with a terminal it does not see at all
Skill	Solving — on the signal of the instruction file overloading	"Content is what matters; the description is a detail, we will fill it in later"	Without a precise trigger description it will not fire at all: the choice goes by the description, and the file's body is not in the context before it fires
MCP			
Subagent			
Process			

What transfers is the decision, not the way it is written down. What counts as a violation, when to intervene, what to move into a separate file, which permissions to cut — that is yours, it does not belong to the tool. The event name, the folder, the form of the answer "no", the units of the time budget — every agent has its own. And there may be no mechanism at all: the decision then still holds, and you have to hold it at another level, often a more reliable one.

"Two rows are filled in. Three stay for the next session."

What appeared in the repository

"On the way into the session there was no .claude/ directory in the repository."

```
github.com/tellina-study/signup-landing-demo    branch seminar-5-hook, commit 9803643

.claude/                                       ← did not exist on the way in
  settings.json                               ← hook · confirmed by a commit
  hooks/selftest-branch-guard.sh              ← hook · confirmed by a commit
  skills/deploy/SKILL.md                      ← skill · planned only, no commit

CLAUDE.md    24 lines / 4 sections → 40 lines / 5 sections ← hook · confirmed by a commit
+ ## Branch protection hook                ← the barrier and who it does NOT stop
+ 3rd item in Repository etiquette          ← written for the hook
```

Two files are confirmed by a commit, one exists only in the plan: a record of future work is not the same as work done.

The same question — a second time

This question was already asked at the start of the session; the answer was not voiced then.

In this repository — with its submission form, its tests and its twenty-four lines of instructions — which of the five would you set up first? Whose answer changed — and what changed it?

hook

skill

MCP

subagent

process

What became checkable over the hour

Под какими строками лежит файл, который можно открыть

хук	барьер стоит и сам печатает свои дыры	settings.json + самотест ветка seminar-5-hook, 9803643
скилл	судьбу решает описание, а не содержимое	описание-триггер во фронтматтере
МСП		
субагент		
процесс		

Under two of the five cards there is now a file: it can be opened and checked with a command. Under the other three there is no such file.

"The three bottom rows are not checked by anything today: all that was said about them is that their stages are ahead. There are no grounds for passing that off as a result."